# Blurt sheet - Unit 3.6 Human resource management

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132

## 3.6.1 HR Objectives & Approaches

- **HR objectives (AQA):** employee engagement, talent development, training, diversity, alignment of values, number, skills and location of employees
- **Soft HRM:** staff treated as a resource to develop
- **Hard HRM:** staff treated as a cost to control

## 3.6.2 HR Data

- **Labour turnover (%):** number of staff leaving ÷ number of staff employed × 100
- **Labour productivity:** output over a time period ÷ number of employees
- **Employee costs as % of turnover:** employee costs ÷ turnover × 100
- **Labour cost per unit:** labour costs ÷ units of output

## 3.6.3 Organisational Structures

- **Functional structure:** organised by department
- **Product-based structure:** organised around products
- **Regional structure:** organised by geographical area
- **Matrix structure:** staff report to a functional manager and a project manager

## 3.6.3 Organisational Design

- **Authority:** right to make decisions
- **Span of control:** number of people a manager directly supervises
- **Hierarchy:** levels of management; tall or flat
- **Delegation:** passing authority to someone lower down
- **Centralisation:** decisions made at the top
- **Decentralisation:** decisions made lower down or locally

## 3.6.3 Human Resource Flow

- **Human resource flow (AQA):** HR plan, recruitment, training, redeployment, redundancy
- **Redeployment:** moving staff to a different role or location within the business
- **Redundancy:** a job is no longer needed

## 3.6.4 Motivation Theory

- **Taylor:** workers motivated by money; one best way; piece rate
- **Maslow's hierarchy:** physiological, safety, love and belonging, esteem, self-actualisation
- **Maslow's key idea:** lower needs must be met first; a satisfied need no longer motivates
- **Herzberg's hygiene factors:** pay, conditions, policy, supervision, security; prevent dissatisfaction
- **Herzberg's motivators:** achievement, recognition, the work itself, responsibility, advancement

## 3.6.4 Financial Methods of Motivation

- **Piece rate:** pay per unit produced
- **Commission:** pay as a % of the value of sales
- **Salary:** fixed annual amount
- **Performance-related pay:** bonus based on an appraisal of performance

## 3.6.4 Non-financial Methods of Motivation

- **Empowerment:** authority to make decisions about own work
- **Team working:** working in groups with shared goals
- **Flexible working:** choice over when or where to work
- **Job enrichment:** more challenging, responsible work
- **Job rotation:** moving between tasks at the same level

## 3.6.5 Employer-Employee Relations

- **Trade union:** represents members in negotiations with employers
- **Works council:** employee and management representatives discussing workplace issues
- **Value of good relations:** fewer disputes, higher motivation, change accepted more easily